



This website lets you virtually travel the world during lockdown

A new website called Windows Swap has been launched by a couple that allows people to travel the world virtually by sharing videos from their windows. The Window Swap project was started by Sonali Ranjit and her husband Vaishnav

Balasubramaniam after they noticed that most of the people were spending their time looking out of the window during the lockdown and wished they could swap places with friends.

The website has drawn more than 2,000 submissions from dozens of countries from Cuba to Afghanistan, and more than a million views as people stuck at home seek to explore the globe. "We realised, we can't swap places, but maybe we can swap windows and pretend that we're there," Ranjit told the Thomson Reuters Foundation, describing how the project started from the couple's one-bed flat in Singapore.

The website invites people to upload a ten-minute video showing their window and view. Visitors can click a button to see a random window anywhere in the world, from a rooftop view in Paris to rain pattering on trees in India. The couple says they hope to keep the site going as long as it remains popular.



Online view website allows people to travel the world virtually by sharing videos from their windows
(Credit: Unsplash)

Tiny audio clips replace wire-coil earbud speakers

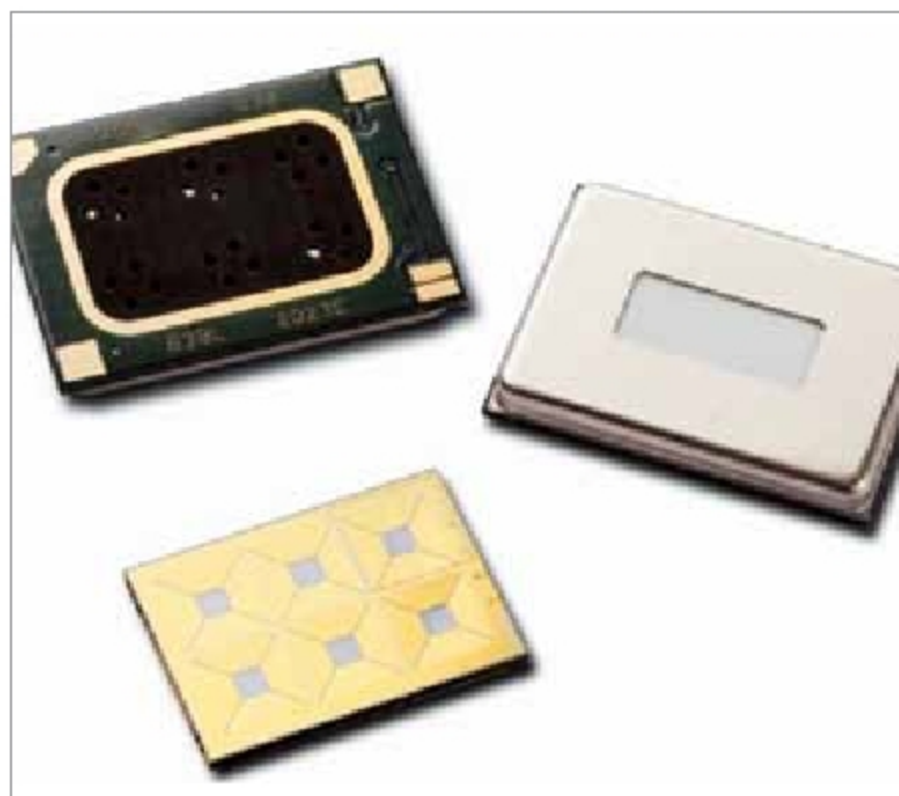
Xmems has unveiled Montara, a new speaker that uses a chip to eliminate bulky and hard-to-manufacture wiring in earbud speakers without sacrificing performance, cost, or reliability.

Montara uses micro-electromechanical systems or MEMS, a semiconductor technology that replaces voice-coil wires used to generate vibration and produce sound waves in speakers.

Santa Clara, California-based Xmems has been in stealth mode since it was founded in October 2017. Now, the company is aiming to replace voice coil speakers that have been around for a century.

"This is the world's first MEMS speaker on a silicon die. The actuator, diaphragm, membrane—everything—is on monolithic silicon die," says Mike Housholder, VP of marketing and business development, Xmems, in an interview with VentureBeat. This means that it is an all-in-one millimetre-thick chip made with solid-state semiconductor technology.

The company claims that its MEMS speaker can produce high-fidelity sound and low total harmonic distortion (THD) needed for sealed, in-ear headphones. Since the components are sealed in a chip, the device is water and dust-resistant, with a rating of IP-57.



Xmems has unveiled Montara, a new speaker that uses a chip to eliminate bulky wiring in earbud speakers (Credit: Xmems)